

KIAAN TECHNOLOGY

THE SaaS DEVELOPMENT CHECKLIST

A practical, phase-by-phase guide to validating, building, launching and scaling a secure SaaS product.

80+ ACTIONABLE CHECKPOINTS

For founders, product teams and businesses planning a custom SaaS platform.

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01 HOW TO USE THIS CHECKLIST

Use this guide before development begins, during sprint reviews, and again before launch. Score each item 1 when complete and 0 when incomplete.

QUICK SCORING METHOD

Each section has 10 checkpoints. Add your section totals at the end. A score below 70 means the product has material launch risk; 70-84 means launch is possible with a remediation plan; 85+ indicates strong readiness.

This checklist helps you answer four critical questions:

DESIRABILITY Do customers have a painful problem and a clear reason to pay for your solution?	FEASIBILITY Can the product be built securely, reliably and within realistic constraints?
VIABILITY Can pricing, acquisition, support and retention create a sustainable business?	READINESS Are operations, analytics, compliance and launch processes prepared for real users?

Project details

Product / Project name

Primary target customer

Product owner

Target launch date

Current development stage

Idea / Prototype / MVP / Live

02 STRATEGY AND MARKET VALIDATION

Confirm that the SaaS solves a meaningful problem for a defined customer segment before committing to full development.

Checklist item	Score
☐ We have defined one primary Ideal Customer Profile (industry, company size, role and geography).	0 1
☐ The customer problem is written in measurable business terms, not only as a feature idea.	0 1
☐ At least 10 target users have been interviewed using non-leading discovery questions.	0 1
☐ We have documented the current workflow, pain points, costs, delays and existing alternatives.	0 1
☐ The proposed value proposition explains why customers should switch or start paying now.	0 1
☐ We have validated willingness to pay through pilots, pre-orders, letters of intent or pricing interviews.	0 1
☐ The competitive landscape includes direct competitors, indirect alternatives and manual processes.	0 1
☐ Our differentiation is difficult to copy and relevant to the buying decision.	0 1
☐ The initial target market is narrow enough for focused sales and marketing.	0 1
☐ Clear success metrics exist for validation, MVP adoption, retention and revenue.	0 1

SECTION SCORE

____ / 10

03 MVP SCOPE AND USER EXPERIENCE

Build the smallest coherent product that delivers the core outcome without creating an unusable or unsafe experience.

Checklist item	Score
☐ One core user journey is prioritized from first login to successful outcome.	0 1
☐ Must-have, should-have, could-have and later features are separated and approved.	0 1
☐ Each MVP feature maps to a validated user problem or business requirement.	0 1
☐ Role-based permissions are defined for every user type before UI development.	0 1
☐ Wireframes cover empty, loading, success, validation, permission and error states.	0 1
☐ Navigation and terminology are understandable to users without staff explanation.	0 1
☐ Onboarding guides users to their first meaningful result as quickly as possible.	0 1
☐ Mobile responsiveness and accessibility expectations are documented.	0 1
☐ User acceptance criteria are written for every critical workflow.	0 1
☐ Out-of-scope items and future phases are recorded to prevent uncontrolled scope growth.	0 1

SECTION SCORE

____ / 10

04 ARCHITECTURE AND MULTI-TENANCY

Design for secure customer isolation, predictable scaling and maintainable future development.

Checklist item	Score
☐ The tenancy model is chosen: shared database, shared schema, separate schema or separate database.	0 1
☐ Every tenant-owned data record has an enforced tenant or organization identifier.	0 1
☐ Authorization checks occur server-side and cannot be bypassed from the frontend.	0 1
☐ Roles, permissions and ownership rules are centrally defined and testable.	0 1
☐ API versioning and backward compatibility expectations are documented.	0 1
☐ Background jobs, queues and scheduled tasks are separated from user-facing requests where needed.	0 1
☐ File storage paths and access controls prevent cross-tenant exposure.	0 1
☐ Database indexing, pagination and query limits are planned for expected usage.	0 1
☐ Critical third-party services have failure handling, retries and timeout policies.	0 1
☐ The architecture decision record explains major technology choices and trade-offs.	0 1

SECTION SCORE

____ / 10

05 SECURITY, PRIVACY AND COMPLIANCE

Security is a product requirement, not a final-stage add-on.

Checklist item	Score
☐ Authentication supports secure password handling and appropriate MFA options.	0 1
☐ Sessions, tokens, password resets and account recovery are securely implemented.	0 1
☐ Least-privilege access is used for users, staff, databases, cloud services and integrations.	0 1
☐ Encryption is enabled in transit and at rest for sensitive information.	0 1
☐ Input validation, output encoding and upload restrictions protect common attack surfaces.	0 1
☐ Audit logs capture important administrative and financial actions.	0 1
☐ Privacy policy, terms, consent and data-retention rules match actual product behavior.	0 1
☐ Users can export, correct or delete their data where required.	0 1
☐ Backups are encrypted, tested and protected from accidental production deletion.	0 1
☐ A vulnerability review and dependency scan are completed before launch.	0 1

SECTION SCORE

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06 SUBSCRIPTIONS, PAYMENTS AND BILLING

Make plan rules, payment states and revenue operations explicit before integrating a gateway.

Checklist item	Score
☐ Pricing plans are linked to specific limits, features, seats or usage allowances.	0 1
☐ Free trial start, expiry, grace period, conversion and data-retention behavior are defined.	0 1
☐ Monthly and annual billing rules, taxes, discounts and coupons are documented.	0 1
☐ The selected payment gateway supports target countries, currencies and business model.	0 1
☐ Webhook signatures are verified and webhook processing is idempotent.	0 1
☐ The system handles payment success, failure, pending, refund, dispute and cancellation states.	0 1
☐ Subscription access is controlled by the backend, not only hidden in the interface.	0 1
☐ Invoices, receipts and billing history are available to authorized users.	0 1
☐ Upgrade, downgrade, proration and cancellation behavior are clearly communicated.	0 1
☐ Finance and support teams can safely investigate billing events without editing raw data.	0 1

SECTION SCORE

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07 **DEVELOPMENT AND QUALITY ASSURANCE**

Use disciplined engineering practices so speed does not create hidden defects and expensive rework.

Checklist item	Score
☐ The repository has protected branches, code review rules and clear ownership.	0 1
☐ Development, staging and production environments are separated.	0 1
☐ Secrets are stored in environment or secret-management systems and never committed to code.	0 1
☐ Code formatting, linting, type checking and automated tests run consistently.	0 1
☐ Critical business logic has unit and integration test coverage.	0 1
☐ Core user journeys have end-to-end tests or repeatable manual test scripts.	0 1
☐ Test data is synthetic and does not expose real customer information.	0 1
☐ Defect severity, triage, retesting and release criteria are defined.	0 1
☐ Browser, device, responsive and accessibility testing cover the supported user base.	0 1
☐ Release notes document features, fixes, migrations, known issues and rollback steps.	0 1

SECTION SCORE

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08 DEPLOYMENT, RELIABILITY AND MONITORING

Prepare the product to operate safely after release, not merely to deploy once.

Checklist item	Score
☐ Infrastructure and deployment steps are automated or fully documented.	0 1
☐ Database migrations are versioned, reviewed and tested on staging backups.	0 1
☐ Rollback procedures exist for application, database and configuration changes.	0 1
☐ Health checks monitor the application, database, queues and critical dependencies.	0 1
☐ Centralized logs include useful context without recording passwords or sensitive data.	0 1
☐ Error tracking alerts the responsible team with enough information to investigate.	0 1
☐ Performance monitoring covers response time, failure rate, throughput and resource use.	0 1
☐ Rate limiting and abuse protection exist for public and high-risk endpoints.	0 1
☐ Recovery time and recovery point expectations are agreed for critical services.	0 1
☐ Production access, emergency changes and incident response are controlled and auditable.	0 1

SECTION SCORE

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09 LAUNCH, ANALYTICS AND CUSTOMER SUCCESS

A launch is successful only when users activate, receive value, remain engaged and can get help.

Checklist item	Score
☐ Analytics events are defined for acquisition, activation, engagement, retention and revenue.	0 1
☐ Consent and privacy settings are respected by analytics and marketing tools.	0 1
☐ Product dashboards answer whether users reach the core value moment.	0 1
☐ Onboarding emails, in-app guidance and help documentation are ready.	0 1
☐ Support channels, operating hours, ownership and escalation paths are published.	0 1
☐ Customer feedback is categorized and connected to product decisions.	0 1
☐ Pilot users and internal staff have completed structured acceptance testing.	0 1
☐ Launch messaging, demo materials, FAQs and sales enablement are prepared.	0 1
☐ A 30-day post-launch review is scheduled with product, engineering, sales and support.	0 1
☐ Retention, churn and expansion actions are assigned to named owners.	0 1

SECTION SCORE

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10 LAUNCH READINESS SCORECARD

Transfer each section score below. Use the result to decide whether to launch, remediate or reduce scope.

Area	Your score	Maximum
Strategy and market validation	_____	10
MVP scope and user experience	_____	10
Architecture and multi-tenancy	_____	10
Security, privacy and compliance	_____	10
Subscriptions, payments and billing	_____	10
Development and quality assurance	_____	10
Deployment, reliability and monitoring	_____	10
Launch, analytics and customer success	_____	10
TOTAL READINESS SCORE	_____	80

Interpret your result

0-55 | HIGH RISK

Do not launch broadly. Revalidate the product, reduce scope and resolve security or operational gaps.

56-69 | NOT READY

Run a focused remediation sprint with owners and deadlines for every critical incomplete item.

70-84 | CONDITIONAL

A controlled pilot may proceed when high-impact risks have mitigation, monitoring and rollback plans.

85-100% | STRONG

The product has a solid readiness foundation. Continue monitoring real-user behavior after launch.

IMPORTANT

A high score does not replace legal, security, financial or industry-specific review. Any critical failure involving access control, data isolation, payments, backups or privacy should block launch until resolved.

11 YOUR 30-60-90 DAY ACTION PLAN

Turn incomplete checklist items into a practical execution plan with owners, priorities and deadlines.

NEXT 30 DAYS

Validate the highest-risk assumptions, finalize MVP scope, approve architecture and resolve critical security decisions.

Priority action	Owner	Due date	Status

DAYS 31-60

Build and test the core journey, integrate essential services, prepare operational tooling and run pilot acceptance.

Priority action	Owner	Due date	Status

DAYS 61-90

Launch carefully, monitor activation and reliability, collect structured feedback and prioritize retention improvements.

Priority action	Owner	Due date	Status

READY TO TURN YOUR SaaS IDEA INTO A SCALABLE PRODUCT?

Kiaan Technology helps businesses plan, design, develop and scale custom SaaS platforms, web applications, mobile apps and automation systems.

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